

## Board 2

South Deals  
None Vul

♠ Q 10 7  
♥ K 9 8 2  
♦ J 10 8 2  
♣ Q 10

♠ 6 4 2  
♥ A Q J 10 6 3  
♦ 5 4  
♣ 7 3

N  
W E  
S

♠ K 9 8 3  
♥ 4  
♦ Q 9 6  
♣ K 9 8 6 5

♠ A J 5  
♥ 7 5  
♦ A K 7 3  
♣ A J 4 2

| West              | North | East | South |
|-------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                   |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass              | 2♦    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass              | 3♥    | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass          |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by South hand. |       |      |       |

You have 9 points, an invitational strength hand. With 6 ♥s you transfer partner by bidding 2♦. Partner replies 2♥.

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Remember, you have invitational strength, so even with a great trump suit you bid just 3♥. Partner puts it in game at 4♥.

The contract would be 4♥ played by North.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♦J and East plays the ♦9.

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4  
Losers are as seen from dummy, the long-trump

You might get lucky in one of the black suits, but your best hope is that West holds the ♥K.

You win the first ♦ and play a ♥ to dummy's ♥10, which wins the trick. You smile. Return to your hand with the other ♦, then play your last ♥ to dummy's ♥J, which wins the trick. But this time you don't smile because East discards! West still holds ♥K 9 and you have no more ♥s to lead for a finesse. Does that finish you?

Never say die. Return to your hand with a black Ace and ruff a ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q 6 and West still has ♥K 9.

Back to your hand with the other black Ace and ruff another ♦ in dummy. Dummy's trumps are now ♥A Q and West still has ♥K 9. Play any black card from dummy, then sit back and wait for your two trump tricks!

Bad trump splits can sometimes be countered by a technique called a trump coup.

The coup is accomplished by ruffing to shorten the trump holding so you won't have to play trumps from that holding.

Pretty much like this hand.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4  
♥ 9 8 6 2  
♦ 5 4  
♣ 8 5 3

♠ A 6 3

♥ K Q 7 3

♦ Q 8 7

♣ J 7 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 8 5 2

♥ J 10 4

♦ 9 6 2

♣ Q 10 9 4

♠ J 9 7

♥ A 5

♦ A K J 10 3

♣ A K 6

|          |       |      |       |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
| West     | North | East | South |
| Pass     | 4NT   | Pass | 2NT   |
| All Pass |       |      | 6NT   |

6NT by South

know West holds ♠Q). In fact, you should even give him some incentive to play another ♠ by dropping your ♠9, pretending to hold just the ♠ J 9. But West noticed his partner's discouraging ♠2 and switched to the ♣8.

You try the ♣J but East plays the ♣Q and you have to win with your ♣K.

Your chances for success are slipping away and you are down to your last hope. Your ♠J is a threat that only West can guard against. If West also is the defender with long ♥s then he would also have to guard dummy's fourth ♥. In that case you could squeeze him. But there is one important play you must make for the squeeze to function.

You must play dummy's ♠A to unblock so your ♠J can be the threat you need. Then play the ♥A, ♣A and 5 ♦ winners.

If West has thrown the ♠Q you win your ♠J and dummy's two high ♥s. But since he probably held onto the ♠Q you just play a ♥ to dummy and hope all three ♥s are winners.

Since West had to guard both the ♥s and your ♠J, he was unable to do both, and the squeeze worked.

You were lucky it wasn't East with the 4 ♥s.

Because of his 3-4-3-3 distribution, partner chose not to look for a ♥ fit. If he had opted for Stayman the contract would have turned out the same. The 4NT response is quantitative, inviting you to bid 6NT if you have a maximum.

You do. 6NT.

South plays 6NT. West leads the ♠K. You will have to make an early decision on whether to hold up or not.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 3 : ♦ = 5 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 11

Only one more winner is needed. You should play a low ♠ from dummy in the hope that West will lead the suit again, giving you a trick with your ♠J (you